If an active internet call is taking place while someone is asking the consumer to conduct a financial transaction, we provide an alert stating that banks and companies do not typically call and ask customers to conduct transactions in this manner. The alert informs the user that the interaction may be fraudulent.

This is awareness-focused security. We secure the user while also creating awareness around potential threats. We have seen positive trends after implementing Protectt.ai with applications. The overall threat has reduced. For example, we have seen cases decline from 100 to around 30 over a period of time, which represents a 70% reduction in alerts generated by the system.

Cybersecurity has long been associated with Israeli and Russian firms. How did Protectt.ai chart its own path?

Manish: Approximately 99% of the global cybersecurity market is controlled by the US and Israel, and these markets have had access to significant research. We built a fully skilled research team. We work with institutes and government organisations and have established our own R&D centre.

Quality was our first focus. Cybersecurity requires continuous research and constant upgrades to security systems, so we built a dedicated team for this purpose.

The third element was the brand. Once we began delivering products with strong capabilities, we were able to match the capabilities of global players and, in some areas, we believe we are better than them.

We are India's first company to build an AI security platform. This has been the result of continuous effort, extensive R&D and product vision. We believe India is well positioned for homegrown security solutions. We call it "Make in India", but we are now taking these solutions to the world. In fact, we now have customers across nine countries apart from India.



INDIAN SHOPPER'S FESTIVE SAFETY CHECK

DON'T LET THE COUNTDOWN MAKE THE DECISION

"Only two left", "sale ends in five minutes" and similar scarcity prompts deserve scrutiny. India's Central Consumer Protection Authority specifically identifies false urgency—fabricated scarcity, popularity or time pressure—as a dark pattern when it is used to push consumers into immediate action. A countdown alone does not prove a scam, but it should never replace verification.



VERIFY THE SELLER OUTSIDE THE AD



A polished Instagram post, search advertisement or professional-looking website is not proof that the seller is genuine. I4C has documented frauds using fake websites, deceptive social-media pages and paid search advertisements. Instead of following the supplied link, independently find the retailer's official website or app. Suspicious URLs, phone numbers, email IDs and other identifiers can also be checked through I4C's "Report and Check Suspect" facility on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal.

REMEMBER: A UPI PIN SENDS MONEY, IT DOESN'T RECEIVE IT

A seller, courier agent or "refund executive" does not need your UPI PIN so that you can receive money. NPCI explicitly warns that scanning a QR code and entering a UPI PIN is for making a payment, not receiving one. Treat any cashback, refund or prize that requires you to enter your PIN as a major warning sign.



DON'T INSTALL AN APP TO CLAIM A DEAL



Be especially cautious if an advertisement, seller or supposed support agent asks you to download an APK or install software from outside the official app store. Malicious apps can be used to steal information or facilitate financial fraud. The scale is significant: the Home Ministry says I4C had blocked 3,718 mobile apps, including fraudulent loan apps, by June 30, 2026.

IF MONEY HAS GONE, SPEED MATTERS

Do not spend hours arguing with the scammer or waiting for the merchant to "fix" the transaction. Contact your bank or payment provider immediately and report the fraud through 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in. India's Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System is designed to act quickly to stop fraudulent funds from being siphoned away. By June 30, 2026, the system had helped save more than ₹11,158 crore across over 32.80 lakh complaints.

